

YUNMI KONG

Department of Economics MS-22

Rice University

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Academic Appointments

2024 - Associate Professor, Rice University
2024 - 2025 Visiting Associate Professor, Cowles Foundation and Yale University
2016 - 2024 Assistant Professor, Rice University

Education

2010 - 2016 Ph.D. in Economics, New York University
2004 - 2008 A.B. in Economics with High Honors, Princeton University

Research Fields

Empirical Industrial Organization, Applied Microeconomics, Applied Microeconometrics

Published and Accepted Articles

- “Not Knowing the Competition: Evidence and Implications for Auction Design” (2020), *RAND Journal of Economics*, Vol. 51, No. 3, pp. 840-867
- “Sequential Auctions with Synergy and Affiliation Across Auctions” (2021), *Journal of Political Economy*, Vol. 129, No. 1, pp. 148-181
- “Multidimensional Auctions of Contracts: An Empirical Analysis” (2022), with Isabelle Perrigne and Quang Vuong, *American Economic Review*, Vol. 112, No. 5, pp. 1703-1736
- “Identification of English Auctions When Losing Entrants Are Not Observed” (2022), *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, Vol. 85, 102875
- “Risk and Information in Dispute Resolution: An Empirical Study of Arbitration” (2025), with Bernardo Silveira and Xun Tang, *Journal of Political Economy*, Vol. 133, No. 9, pp. 2794-2835

Working Papers

- “Liquid Markets: An Empirical Analysis of a Water Exchange”
- “Moving Auctions Online,” with Shosuke Noguchi

Seminars and Conference Presentations

2025-2026 Michigan State University, Iowa State University, European Meeting of the Econometric Society-Dublin
2024-2025 Yale, IO+ Conference at UChicago, Columbia, UT Austin, HKUST, ASSA Meetings
2023-2024 NYU Stern, IU Bloomington, Georgia Tech, Penn State, Boston College, U. Michigan, U. Wisconsin-Madison, Barcelona Summer Forum, EARIE-Amsterdam
2022-2023 Queen’s University, MIT, UC Berkeley environmental and energy economics, Harvard, Caltech, Northwestern, Seoul National University, Rice-Sciences Po IO conference, Cowles Conference on Models and Measurement, NBER Summer Institute IO
2021-2022 Cornell, SEA Meetings, ASSA Meetings, WUSTL, IIOC, Queen Mary University of London, IAAE London, UBC Summer IO Conference

2020-2021	Colby College, Carnegie Mellon, KAEA virtual seminar series, Stanford, UBC Sauder, PUC-Rio, Cowles Conference on Models and Measurement, Barcelona GSE Summer Forum, IO ² virtual seminar
2019-2020	DOJ, U of Toronto, Columbia, SEA Meetings
2018-2019	WUSTL Olin, Texas A&M, Lancaster Conference on “auctions, competition, regulation, and public policy,” IAAE Nicosia, SITE, Banff Empirical Microeconomics Conference
2017-2018	NYU Alumni Conference, Midwest Econometrics Group, UT Austin, Yonsei Young Economist Workshop, Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society (Seoul)
2016-2017	Yale, ASSA Meetings, Texas Camp Econometrics, IAAE Sapporo
2015-2016	SITE, 11th World Congress of the Econometric Society, USC, Carnegie Mellon, Chicago Booth, Chicago Harris, Rice, U Penn, FDIC, U of Minnesota, FTC

Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

2026	Top Reviewers Award for IJIO in 2025
2022	KAEA Young Scholar Award
2018	Malcolm Gillis Award for Distinction in Undergraduate Teaching in Economics, Rice
2010 - 2015	MacCracken Graduate Fellowship, NYU
2015	Dean’s Student Travel Grant, NYU
2015	CV Starr Center Travel Grant, NYU
2011	Pass with distinction in the qualifying exam in Microeconomics, NYU
2008	Phi Beta Kappa, Princeton University
2005	Shapiro Prize for Academic Excellence, Princeton University
2002	USAMO Qualification and Akamai Foundation AIME Scholarship

Teaching

Data Analysis for Market Design, Undergraduate (Rice University): Spring 2026
 Empirical Microeconomics, PhD (Rice University): Spring 2023, 2024, 2026
 Applied Econometrics, Undergraduate (Rice University): 2016-2023
 Seminar Workshop, PhD (Rice University): Fall 2020, Fall 2021

Refereeing

AEJ: Microeconomics, AER: Insights, American Economic Review, Applied Economics Letters, Econometrica, Economic Journal, Empirical Economics, Games and Economic Behavior, International Economic Review, International Journal of Industrial Organization, Journal of Applied Econometrics, Journal of Business and Economic Statistics, Journal of Econometrics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Industrial Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of the European Economic Association, Quantitative Economics, RAND Journal of Economics, Review of Economic Design, Review of Economic Studies

Discussant

Montreal IO conference (2024), ASSA annual meeting (2024), NBER IO spring meeting (2023), ASSA annual meeting (2023), IIOC (2022), SEA (2021), KWEN virtual seminar series (2020), Lancaster Conference on “auctions, competition, regulation, and public policy” (2019), ASSA annual meeting (2019)

Other Professional Service

Program Committee, Area Chair of empirical IO and auctions, IAAE Conference 2025 & 2026
 Organizer, “Bringing Models to Data in Microeconomics” paper session, ASSA Annual Meeting 2023
 Organizer, “KAEA Mentoring Workshop I – Microeconomics”, ASSA Annual Meeting 2023
 Organizer, Korean Women Economist Network (KWEN) Virtual Seminar Series, 2022

University and Department Service

University Graduate Council 2026-27

Graduate Admissions Committee 2016-17 to 2018-19, 2025-26, 2026-27

Graduate Program Committee 2019-20 to 2021-22, 2026-27

Junior Faculty Triad Mentoring Program in Humanities and Social Sciences, Mentor 2025-26

Faculty Recruiting Committee 2018-19 and 2023-24

Undergraduate Committee 2022-23, 2023-24

Empirical Micro Seminar Co-organizer 2023-24

Second Year Graduate Research Seminar Organizer 2019-20

PhD Advising

- Chair/Co-chair for: Shosuke Noguchi (PhD 2025), Giovanni Aiello (2025), Jingyun Huang (2026)
- Committee member for: Yingying Xu (2019), Daniel Prudencio (2021), Igor Hernandez (2022), Suguru Otani (2024), Yuri Matsumura (2025), Kai Liao (2026), Masoud Jabbari (2026), Defne Sandikcioglu (2028), Naiwen Pang (2028), Jorge Zazueta (2028)

Other Publications

Shub, Daniel E., Suzanne P. Carr, Yunmi Kong, and H. Steven Colburn (2008), "Discrimination and identification of azimuth using spectral shape," *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 124(5): 3132-3141.